THE WITNESS REMAINS

THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION - THE BARRAN DODGER PUBLIC TESTIMONY, DOCUMENTARY RECORD AND EVIDENCE INDEX

DR RICHARD WILLIAM McLEAN — BARRAN DODGER
TRUTH DOES NOT NEED PERMISSION TO EXIST.

LIES NEED CONSTANT UPKEEP. MY TRUTH NEEDED TIME. BY GOD'S GRACE, I AM STILL HERE.

Primary archive: Barran Dodger — original documentary archive
Rebuilt archive: Barran Dodger — preservation and rebuild site
Primary GitHub evidence repository: github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger
Rebuild repository: github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild
Repository index file: Original archive index.html

READER'S GUIDE: HOW TO FOLLOW THE RECORD

This document is my first-person testimony and a guide to the documentary history I have preserved.

I am Dr Richard William McLean, known publicly as Barran Dodger. I have assembled the Barran Dodger Archive to preserve and organise a substantial body of material concerning my life, research, professional work, correspondence, dealings with institutions, faith and efforts to pursue accountability and practical security.

I want readers to be able to move between my account and the documents supporting it. The links in this document direct readers to my public archive and GitHub repositories. Where a specific source document has not yet been linked to an individually verified file URL, the repository link provides the starting point for locating it. I will not invent a filename or pretend that a link leads to a particular document when I have not verified that exact address.

Evidence and context index

- **Primary documentary repository:** Barrandodger GitHub repository
- **Original public archive:** Barran Dodger website
- **Rebuilt public archive:** Barran Dodger rebuild
- **Rebuild source repository:** barrandodger-rebuild on GitHub
- **Original website index:** index.html

My archive contains a preservation project based on a 660-page site index, with material

organised into website pages, PDFs, links and preservation records. The original repository is the starting point for exploring that material.

This is a finding aid as well as a testimony. Its purpose is to help readers locate records, follow chronology, distinguish documents from commentary and understand why I believe the material matters.

The evidence is not presented as though every document proves every conclusion. I want the underlying records read in their actual context. I also insist that my own account of the human consequences remains part of the record.

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PART I — MY TESTIMONY

1. I AM THE PERSON WHO LIVED THIS HISTORY

My name is Dr Richard William McLean. I am Barran Dodger. I hold a PhD from Victoria University, awarded in 2020. I wrote *Recovered, Not Cured*, published by Allen & Unwin in 2003, and I have worked as an illustrator, news graphics artist and cartoonist.

I have spent years documenting what I believe to be a profound failure of institutional responsibility, protection, accountability and basic human decency.

I have approached government departments, oversight bodies, financial institutions, disability services, legal assistance services, hospitals, mental-health organisations, universities, publishers, galleries, journalists, advocacy organisations and elected representatives.

I have pursued correspondence, complaints, Freedom of Information requests, administrative reviews, workers' compensation matters and other pathways in an effort to obtain answers and assistance.

I have preserved documents because I refuse to allow my life to be reduced to somebody else's administrative summary.

I am not the person who should be embarrassed by this record. The organisations whose conduct I have documented should be prepared to answer for their own words, decisions and actions.

I have experienced prolonged insecurity, financial hardship, isolation, difficulty obtaining practical assistance and the exhausting responsibility of trying to preserve a complicated documentary history while living through its consequences.

I have had to become the archivist of my own experience. I have organised correspondence, preserved official records, maintained an index, linked documents and tried to make a complicated history intelligible to other people.

I have done this because I believe the record matters.

I refuse to let institutional language sanitise what I have lived through. I refuse to allow a referral to masquerade as a resolution, an acknowledgement to masquerade as meaningful

assistance, or a list of completed processes to be presented as proof that a person's circumstances have been adequately addressed.
I am done writing my life in a language designed to make institutions comfortable.
I am telling my story in my own voice.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger original archive · GitHub evidence repository · Rebuilt archive

2. THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION

The central contradiction in my experience is simple.
I have approached systems whose stated purposes include protecting vulnerable people, investigating wrongdoing, safeguarding human rights, supporting people with disability, providing access to justice and ensuring accountability.
Yet I have experienced prolonged insecurity, financial hardship, isolation, housing difficulties and repeated struggles to obtain the practical assistance and substantive engagement I sought.
I have been forced to navigate systems that operate separately while I live with the combined consequences of the circumstances I have documented.
One office refers a matter elsewhere. Another explains its jurisdiction. Another sets out its limits. Another issues a letter. Another restricts a pathway.
I am the person who remains after the correspondence has been sent.
I am the person who still needs somewhere safe to live, the means to communicate, access to necessities and the ability to continue preserving the record.
I reject the assumption that the existence of a support system proves that I have received the support I needed.
I reject the assumption that the existence of a complaint mechanism proves that the underlying concern has been addressed.
I reject the assumption that institutional authority makes institutional conduct immune from scrutiny.
I have lived the difference between a system that can process a person and a system that actually helps a person.
My archive exists because I refuse to let the wider history disappear into disconnected administrative files.
Evidence and context: Original archive · Rebuild and preservation project · Original GitHub repository

3. FINANCE AND THE CDDC SCHEME

My financial history, including matters concerning the CDDC scheme and associated administrative processes, forms part of the wider documentary history I have been trying to preserve.
Financial insecurity is not an abstract category when it affects a person's ability to maintain housing, pay bills, communicate, obtain necessities and pursue the answers they believe they need.
I reject the compartmentalisation of financial questions from the wider circumstances in

which they arose.
I have had to devote extraordinary time and energy to preserving records and pursuing answers while also dealing with the practical consequences of financial hardship.
I want the relevant CDDC and financial records read alongside the broader chronology, including the correspondence, decisions and supporting documents available in my archive.
I will not allow financial difficulties to be portrayed as though they exist independently of the wider history I have documented.
Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original archive
Document locator: Search the repository and archive for the CDDC scheme, finance-related correspondence and associated decision records. Individual document links should be added once their exact repository paths are verified.

4. FREEDOM OF INFORMATION: THE FIGHT TO KEEP THE RECORD VISIBLE

Freedom of Information should allow people to obtain government-held records. I have pursued FOI because documentary evidence matters and because the public record matters.
My archive records the history surrounding PM&C FOI/2022/045, including an initial response indicating that no documents were held and a revised response dated 8 October 2024 that released five documents.
My records also include OAIC reference RQ22/00794 and correspondence concerning approximately 1,187 PM&C Outlook items under review.
These are not meaningless administrative numbers to me. They form part of my effort to understand what records exist, what searches were undertaken, what was released and how the documentary history fits together.
I have had to preserve the correspondence, maintain the chronology and organise the material so the history does not disappear into a succession of separate administrative responses.
I refuse to let procedural complexity make the record practically inaccessible.
I should not have to become an archivist, investigator, indexer and preservation specialist simply to keep track of a history I have spent years trying to explain.
I have preserved the paper trail because I refuse to let the paper trail be buried.
Evidence and context: Original repository · Original archive index · Public archive
Document locator: PM&C FOI/2022/045; OAIC RQ22/00794; revised FOI response dated 8 October 2024; correspondence concerning the approximately 1,187 Outlook items. Exact source-file URLs should be inserted after locating the corresponding files in the repository.

5. IBAC AND ICAC: INTEGRITY MUST MEAN SOMETHING

IBAC and ICAC form part of Australia's public-integrity landscape. Their mandates invoke investigation, accountability and the expectation that serious concerns about public conduct can be raised.
I have pursued accountability through available pathways because I believe the matters I have documented deserve serious attention.
My criticism is directed at the experience of trying to pursue answers while continuing to carry the consequences myself.

A complaint lodged is not the same as a concern resolved. A reference number is not an explanation. A referral is not, by itself, an answer to the substance of the matter.
I want the chronology and supporting records read together. I want the distinction between what I submitted, what an organisation communicated and what followed to remain visible.
I refuse to allow the existence of an integrity body to become a shield against examining my experience.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger documentary repository · Public archive
Document locator: Search the archive for IBAC, ICAC, complaint correspondence, submission records and any responses preserved in the repository. Each relevant submission and response should be linked individually when its exact URL is verified.

6. THE OMBUDSMAN AND THE SERVICE-RESTRICTION LETTER

My records include correspondence with the Commonwealth Ombudsman and an Ombudsman service-restriction letter dated 8 August 2025.
That letter forms part of the history of my attempts to pursue answers through official channels.
I experienced the restriction as another serious barrier in a prolonged effort to have my concerns heard. I was still the person living with the consequences, still the person preserving the evidence and still the person trying to make sense of the history.
I will not pretend that a restriction letter is the same thing as a resolution.
I will not allow that letter to erase the events and correspondence that preceded it.
I want the document read in sequence, with its date, wording and context preserved. I want the wider chronology to remain visible.
Evidence and context: Original archive · GitHub evidence repository
Document locator: Commonwealth Ombudsman correspondence; service-restriction letter dated 8 August 2025; associated complaint and referral records.

7. THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE

My archive includes a note associated with the office of Prime Minister Anthony Albanese dated 12 December 2022 stating that my email had not been forwarded.
I preserve this detail because it is part of the documentary history of my attempts to bring my concerns to government.
I have approached public offices seeking attention to matters I regard as serious. I have retained the resulting correspondence because I refuse to let the history become a vague recollection that I contacted a government office.
Governments speak about accountability, transparency, inclusion and public service. I have had to preserve the documents recording my own attempts to engage with those systems.
I will not allow the prestige of a political office to make its correspondence immune from scrutiny.
I want the record read in context: what I raised, when I raised it, what the office communicated and what followed.
Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original archive index
Document locator: Prime Minister's office note dated 12 December 2022; related email and

correspondence.

8. THE ATTORNEY-GENERAL'S DEPARTMENT AND THE REFERRAL TRAIL

My archive includes Attorney-General's Department correspondence dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, concerning referrals to the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security and the Ombudsman.

It also includes correspondence dated 6 February 2025, reference MC25-000321, concerning a referral to the Victorian Minister for Police.

I have preserved these documents because they form part of the chronology of my attempts to pursue answers.

I refuse to let the act of forwarding correspondence become the end of the story.

The person who raises a concern does not stop existing when the matter is referred. The circumstances do not disappear. The practical consequences do not vanish.

I want the documents read in sequence, alongside the concerns I raised and the subsequent responses recorded in my archive.

Evidence and context: Barran Dodger evidence repository · Original archive

Document locator: AGD MC23-028244, 19 September 2023; AGD MC25-000321, 6 February 2025; related referral correspondence.

9. WHISTLEBLOWING AND THE PRICE OF SPEAKING

Whistleblowing is praised when it is convenient. Institutions speak about integrity, transparency and the importance of exposing wrongdoing.

My experience has made the personal cost of speaking out impossible to separate from those ideals.

I have spent years documenting matters that I believe deserve public attention. I have continued preserving records when the work has consumed time, energy and resources I needed for rebuilding my life.

I have experienced isolation and exclusion while trying to maintain the record. I have had to keep explaining the relationship between documents, events and the consequences I describe.

It is easy to celebrate the abstract idea of a courageous whistleblower. It is harder to confront the human being who must continue living after the disclosure, the complaint, the correspondence and the public silence.

I refuse to let my story be celebrated in theory while the person telling it is ignored in practice.

Evidence and context: Public archive · GitHub repository · Rebuilt archive

10. POLICE-RELATED RECORDS AND STATEMENTS ATTRIBUTED TO OTHERS

My archive includes material concerning police-related matters and statements attributed to people whose communications I have preserved.

I have referred to a saved PDF containing messages attributed to Ben, which I have described as recording statements about fear for his own safety, an alleged incident described as a "close call", and an account he attributed to police concerning an allegedly fabricated report.

I want the original messages, dates and precise wording preserved and read in context.

I will not erase serious statements from my testimony because they are uncomfortable. Nor will I present an attributed statement as though it independently establishes every surrounding event.
The distinction between a message, the words of its author, my understanding of those words and the underlying events matters.
I have worked to preserve the material because I believe it forms part of the history that readers need to understand.
Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original public archive
Document locator: PDF of the messages attributed to Ben; related saved message records; associated timestamps and contextual correspondence. The exact document URL should be inserted once located.

11. HUMAN RIGHTS AND INTERNATIONAL PATHWAYS

I have pursued human-rights-related avenues because I believe my circumstances raise serious questions about dignity, treatment, protection and accountability.
My archive includes material concerning the Australian Human Rights Commission and international human-rights pathways, including references associated with the United Nations.
I have tried to make the documentary history accessible because I want my experience understood in its full context, not reduced to one incident or one administrative category.
Human rights are not meaningful to a person merely because an organisation can describe them in a policy document.
I refuse to let the language of human rights become ceremonial vocabulary that sounds impressive in public while the person seeking assistance remains unheard.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger repository · Original archive
Document locator: AHRC correspondence, United Nations-related references, submissions, acknowledgements and supporting documents preserved in the archive.

12. THE NDIS AND DISABILITY SUPPORT

My dealings with disability-related systems form a significant part of my history.
My records include correspondence from the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission dated 3 June 2021 concerning my employment status. That letter is relevant to the wider history of my workers' compensation and employment-related concerns.
I have sought practical assistance while dealing with the wider consequences of my circumstances. I have also had to navigate administrative processes that address different aspects of a person's life separately.
I refuse to let the existence of a support system be mistaken for proof that the person has received the support they needed.
I have experienced the burden of connecting separate records, explaining the relationship between different events and preserving a coherent chronology.
I am the person who has had to live through that fragmentation.
Evidence and context: Original repository · Original archive index
Document locator: NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission letter dated 3 June 2021;

related disability support and employment-status correspondence.

13. NSW TRUSTEE & GUARDIAN: THE REALITY BEHIND THE FIGURES

My dealings with NSW Trustee & Guardian form part of the practical record of my struggle to obtain assistance.

My records include correspondence concerning an offer of an additional $100 per week, alongside the position that my full pension meant no further funding was available and that the agency did not source accommodation.

I have also sought help with an electricity bill of approximately $200.

These are not abstract administrative details. Electricity, accommodation, food and communication are the practical foundations of daily survival.

When a person is struggling to maintain basic security, an explanation of funding boundaries does not make the electricity bill disappear. A statement that accommodation is not sourced by a particular organisation does not provide a home.

I will not allow an administrative description of my circumstances to replace the reality of living through them.

Evidence and context: Barran Dodger repository · Public archive

Document locator: NSW Trustee & Guardian correspondence concerning the additional $100 weekly allowance, accommodation responsibilities and the electricity-bill request.

14. THE PUBLIC GUARDIAN AND NCAT

My history includes a review concerning the Public Guardian through the NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal.

I have had to navigate formal processes concerning my circumstances while continuing to manage the practical consequences of my wider history.

I regard these matters as part of a broader question of autonomy, dignity, support and the effect of administrative decisions on an actual human life.

I refuse to be reduced to a file, a classification or an administrative problem.

I am a person with a history, a body of work, a documentary record and my own account of what I have experienced.

Evidence and context: Original archive · GitHub repository

Document locator: Public Guardian review material from October 2025; relevant NCAT correspondence, applications and decisions.

15. HOUSING INSECURITY AND HOMELESSNESS

I have described periods of profound housing insecurity, including living in my car with my therapy dog.

I will not dress that experience up in bureaucratic language to make it sound less confronting than it was.

A person who has spent years pursuing answers, preserving evidence and navigating support systems should not have to explain away the basic human reality of needing somewhere safe to live.

Housing insecurity affects everything: sleep, privacy, communication, financial stability, the storage of documents and the ability to rebuild a life.

I refuse to allow homelessness to be treated as an isolated administrative circumstance detached from the wider history I have documented.
I know what it means to struggle for basic security while trying to keep a complicated documentary record intact.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger archive · GitHub evidence repository
Document locator: Personal testimony, accommodation-related correspondence and records documenting requests for practical support.

16. LEGAL AID AND ACCESS TO ASSISTANCE

My experience includes Legal Aid refusals and restrictions.
I have sought assistance in circumstances where I believed I needed meaningful support to understand and pursue matters affecting my life.
I have also had to preserve my own documents, organise the chronology and work through complex administrative material while dealing with the practical consequences of my circumstances.
I am one person trying to maintain an extensive documentary history. I do not have the resources of a government department or a legal institution.
I refuse to let the difficulty of obtaining assistance erase the substance of what I have documented.
The history of seeking help is itself part of the history.
Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original archive
Document locator: Legal Aid applications, refusals, restrictions and related correspondence preserved in the archive.

17. COMCARE, EMPLOYMENT STATUS AND WORKERS' COMPENSATION

My workers' compensation history includes a Comcare refusal dated 26 May 2021, which raised the question of whether I met the employee-status requirements under section 5 of the Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act.
My archive also includes the NDIS Commission correspondence dated 3 June 2021 and a January 2024 Federal Court-related letter from Scott Treadwell that I understand to support my position concerning my employment by the Department of Social Services.
I believe these records are important to the employment-status questions I have been trying to resolve.
I want the documents examined together. The dates, wording, statutory questions and relationship between the records matter.
I have had to keep track of complex correspondence and competing institutional positions while living with the consequences of my circumstances.
I refuse to let the complexity of workers' compensation administration obscure the questions I have been trying to establish.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger evidence repository · Original archive index
Document locator: Comcare refusal dated 26 May 2021; NDIS Commission letter dated 3 June 2021; Scott Treadwell correspondence from January 2024; related employment-status and compensation records.

18. ADMINISTRATIVE REVIEWS AND THE BURDEN OF REPEATING MY HISTORY

My dealings with administrative review pathways form part of the wider documentary record. The burden of pursuing reviews is not simply the time spent filling out forms. It is the repeated requirement to reconstruct a history, organise evidence, explain context and respond to institutional descriptions of one's circumstances.

I have devoted years to preserving my own records because I cannot assume that each new process will carry forward the full history of the previous one.

I refuse to let a fragmented administrative record become the definitive account of my life.

Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Public archive

Document locator: Administrative review applications, decisions, correspondence and related records.

19. HOSPITALS, PSYCHIATRY AND COERCIVE TREATMENT

I have described sixteen psychiatric hospitalisations across my history.

I have also described experiences of coercive treatment, including injections and what I experienced as chemical restraint. I believe these experiences must be understood in the context of my wider circumstances, my attempts to communicate my concerns and the consequences I have lived with.

I will not pretend that such experiences are minor simply because they occurred within healthcare institutions.

Being hospitalised, subjected to treatment experienced as coercive and trying to explain one's circumstances within a psychiatric setting can have profound consequences for a person's sense of safety, autonomy and dignity.

I have felt that my attempts to speak about serious concerns were interpreted through a psychiatric lens in ways that undermined my ability to be heard. I believe that history deserves serious examination.

I reject the idea that a person's mental-health history should be used to make the rest of their testimony disappear.

I am more than my hospital history. I am a person with academic work, professional experience, creative work, faith and a documentary archive.

I am entitled to describe what I experienced and preserve the records relevant to it.

Evidence and context: Original archive · GitHub evidence repository

Document locator: Personal testimony, available hospital and treatment records, relevant correspondence and documents concerning the circumstances I have described. Individual medical documents should be linked only where they are intentionally included in the public archive.

20. SANE AUSTRALIA: THE GAP BETWEEN ENGAGEMENT AND SUPPORT

I have described an experience with SANE Australia in which I felt my work and lived experience were welcomed and praised, but I ultimately felt abandoned when I needed meaningful support.

I regard that contrast as deeply disappointing.

Organisations associated with mental-health support speak publicly about compassion, recovery, inclusion and listening to lived experience. I have felt the difference between being engaged when my story could serve an organisation's purposes and being supported when I needed something more substantial.
I refuse to pretend that praise is the same as practical assistance.
I refuse to treat engagement as proof of meaningful support when my experience of the relationship was that I was left carrying the burden alone.
I want the relevant communications and chronology preserved so readers can understand what occurred, what was said and how I experienced the outcome.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger archive · GitHub repository
Document locator: SANE Australia correspondence, communications and relevant records of engagement. Exact document links should be inserted when located.

21. THE ASYLUM SEEKERS RESOURCE CENTRE

I have described approaching the Asylum Seekers Resource Centre in the context of seeking assistance as an asylum seeker and feeling that I did not receive the practical help I needed.
I regard that experience as deeply disappointing given the organisation's public association with supporting asylum seekers and people experiencing vulnerability.
I know that organisations have defined services and eligibility requirements. I refuse to let those explanations erase the human experience of seeking help and feeling abandoned.
Public commitments to compassion mean little to the person who approaches for assistance and leaves feeling unsupported.
I want my account and the relevant records preserved in the context of my wider circumstances.
Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original archive
Document locator: ASRC correspondence and records of requests for assistance, where included in the archive.

22. VICTORIA UNIVERSITY AND MY RESEARCH

I hold a PhD from Victoria University, awarded in 2020.
I have expressed serious concerns about the treatment, recognition and presentation of my research. I believe aspects of my work have been diminished or delegitimised in the broader history I have documented.
I want my research assessed on its substance, methods, documentary foundations and arguments rather than reduced to assumptions about me as a person.
My academic history does not make me infallible. It does mean that my work should be engaged with as work: read, understood, questioned and discussed on its substance.
I refuse to let my psychiatric history become a shortcut for dismissing everything I have researched, written or documented.
My research is part of my record. My archive preserves the material. I want the substance to remain visible.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger repository · Original archive
Document locator: PhD-related material, research documents, correspondence and relevant

publications preserved in the archive.

23. GALLERIES, CURATORS AND MY CREATIVE WORK

I have described experiences in the art world that I regard as exploitative and have raised concerns about the way my work has been used, presented or interpreted.

My criticism is that an artist's work can be welcomed, displayed, collected or made useful to an institution while the artist's own circumstances, voice and interests receive inadequate attention.

Art is not detached from the human being who creates it.

My work has its own history, context and meaning. I will not accept that other people should be able to define that meaning while ignoring my account of the circumstances surrounding it.

Where I believe my work has been treated unfairly, I want the relevant correspondence, publication records and other evidence preserved.

A gallery wall does not make an interpretation neutral. A catalogue entry does not exhaust an artist's history. A collection does not give other people the final word on the person whose work they hold.

Evidence and context: Barran Dodger archive · GitHub evidence repository

Document locator: Relevant artwork records, catalogue material, correspondence and publications. Individual gallery and curator names should be linked to the exact source documents once identified in the repository.

24. THE DAX COLLECTION AND THE REDUCTION OF ART TO MADNESS

I have raised particular concerns about the DAX Collection and the way I believe my art has been framed in relation to mental illness.

My objection is not to discussing mental health in art. My objection is to having my creative work interpreted through a framework that, in my view, risks reducing the artist to a psychiatric category and allowing that category to dominate the meaning of the work.

I am more than a diagnosis, a hospital history or somebody else's curatorial explanation.

I am a person with an intellectual history, professional experience, creative work, research, writing, faith and a documentary record.

I will not accept the reduction of my art to a convenient story about madness when I believe the wider context of my life and work has been neglected.

My art is not permission for other people to erase my voice.

Evidence and context: Original archive · GitHub repository

Document locator: DAX Collection references, relevant artwork descriptions, exhibition or catalogue material, and my own records concerning the presentation of my work.

25. ALLEN & UNWIN AND THE STORY I BELIEVE REMAINS UNTOLD

Allen & Unwin published my book *Recovered, Not Cured* in 2003.

That publication forms part of my professional history and my long-standing engagement with questions of recovery, mental health and lived experience.

I have since expressed profound frustration about my efforts to bring attention to a story that I regard as central to a major disability-whistleblower history in Australia, and about my

experience of not securing the publishing engagement I sought.
I believe the story I have been trying to tell deserves serious consideration. I believe the documentary material I have preserved gives readers a substantial basis for understanding why I regard it as important.
My criticism concerns the gulf I have experienced between the promise of publishing important stories and my own difficulty in finding a platform for this particular account.
I refuse to let the absence of a publishing contract determine whether my experience is worth documenting.
That is why I built an archive.
When the story could not find the platform I sought, I continued preserving the documents.
When I could not rely on a publisher to carry the whole history, I worked to make the material accessible myself.
My evidence is not for sale, and my voice is not dependent on a publisher's permission to exist.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger archive · GitHub evidence repository
Document locator: Recovered, Not Cured (2003); related publishing correspondence and material concerning my subsequent attempts to present my wider story.

26. THE MEDIA AND THE STORY THAT HAS STRUGGLED TO BE HEARD

I have worked in media and visual communication. I understand the power of public storytelling, the importance of evidence and the role journalism can play in bringing complex matters to public attention.
I have experienced profound frustration with the lack of media coverage I believe my story warrants.
I have spent years assembling documentary material and trying to make the history intelligible. I have preserved records because I believe they matter, not because I expect every journalist to agree with my interpretation.
I refuse to accept that a story becomes unworthy of examination merely because it is complicated, difficult to summarise or challenging to fit into a conventional news cycle.
I have made the archive public because I want readers, researchers and journalists to be able to examine the material directly.
I cannot compel a newsroom to publish my story. I can preserve the record, make it accessible and speak plainly about my experience of being unable to secure the coverage I sought.
I will not mistake media silence for proof that my history has nothing to say.
Evidence and context: Original archive · GitHub evidence repository · Rebuilt archive
Document locator: Media correspondence, approaches, responses and related records preserved in the archive.

27. ADVOCACY ORGANISATIONS AND THE USE OF LIVED EXPERIENCE

I have dealt with organisations whose public missions include advocacy, disability rights, mental-health support, inclusion and protection.
My experience has left me angry about the gap I perceive between public advocacy and the

treatment of the individual person who approaches for help.
Lived experience is frequently praised in campaigns, policy statements, research projects and organisational messaging. But lived experience is not a slogan. It belongs to an actual human being whose circumstances continue after the meeting, interview, campaign or report has ended.
I refuse to be treated as useful when my story illustrates an organisation's mission and inconvenient when I need sustained practical support.
I refuse to have my experience turned into a resource for other people's credibility while my own needs remain unresolved.
Where I have felt praised, engaged, encouraged or used and then left unsupported, I will describe that experience honestly and preserve the relevant records.
Do not celebrate lived experience when it is useful to your mission and then turn away from the person living it when the consequences become uncomfortable.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger archive · GitHub repository

28. POLITICIANS, MINISTERS AND PUBLIC OFFICES

I have approached political and government offices because I believed my circumstances deserved attention.
My archive preserves correspondence and referrals associated with government offices, departments and representatives.
I am angry about the experience of trying to bring a serious history to the attention of people and offices associated with public responsibility while continuing to live with the consequences myself.
Public office carries responsibilities. I refuse to let a referral, acknowledgement or administrative note be presented as though it necessarily answers the substance of a person's concerns.
I want the record read. I want the correspondence understood. I want the sequence preserved.
I will not pretend that my experience has been satisfactory simply because an office has replied.
Evidence and context: Original GitHub repository · Original archive index

29. AUSTRALIANSUPER, AFCA AND FINANCIAL DISPUTE PATHWAYS

My archive includes matters concerning AustralianSuper and financial or insurance-related pathways, including the Australian Financial Complaints Authority.
I have pursued these matters as part of a broader effort to understand and address the financial consequences of my circumstances.
I refuse to allow each financial or insurance-related process to be considered so narrowly that its connection to the circumstances I have documented becomes invisible.
I want the relevant records and decisions read on their own terms and in the context of the broader chronology.
Evidence and context: Barran Dodger evidence repository · Public archive
Document locator: AustralianSuper records, AFCA correspondence and associated financial

or insurance-related documents.

30. WORKSAFE, DXC AND EMPLOYMENT-RELATED MATTERS

My documentary history includes employment-related and administrative matters involving WorkSafe, DXC and associated processes.

These matters form part of the wider record I have been trying to assemble concerning employment status, institutional responsibility, claims and the consequences I have experienced.

I want the relevant correspondence, decisions and supporting material read together rather than scattered across disconnected processes.

I refuse to allow a complicated employment-related history to be reduced to unrelated administrative entries.

Evidence and context: GitHub evidence repository · Original archive

Document locator: WorkSafe and DXC-related correspondence, employment records, claims material and associated administrative documents.

31. THE CUMULATIVE CONSEQUENCES: THIS IS A LIFE, NOT A COLLECTION OF FILES

Each organisation has its own procedures. Each process has its own correspondence. Each office may describe a narrow part of my circumstances.

But I have not lived these experiences as separate files.

I have lived them as one person.

Financial insecurity affects housing. Housing insecurity affects communication and the preservation of records. Isolation affects the ability to pursue assistance. Repeated administrative demands consume time and energy. Difficult experiences in healthcare affect trust. The absence of practical support compounds existing difficulties.

The cumulative burden matters.

I refuse to allow the history to be fragmented until every organisation can point to a narrow part of it and the overall human consequences disappear from view.

I have spent years trying to maintain continuity across a history that has repeatedly required me to explain myself again.

I have had to preserve the documents, retain the chronology, organise the evidence and continue telling the story.

That is labour. It is exhausting labour. And I have undertaken it while dealing with the consequences of the history itself.

I will not let administrative activity be mistaken for human relief. I will not let a list of processes replace an honest account of what I have lived through.

Evidence and context: Original archive · Original repository · Rebuilt archive

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PART II — THE EVIDENCE AND CONTEXT INDEX

32. GOVERNMENT, OVERSIGHT AND ADMINISTRATIVE CORRESPONDENCE

The following index identifies key records and organisations referenced in my testimony. It is intended to help readers locate and cross-reference the documentary material in the archive.

Organisation or process	Record or issue to locate
PM&C / Prime Minister's office	Note dated 12 December 2022 stating that my email had not been forwarded
PM&C FOI	FOI/2022/045, initial response and revised release dated 8 October 2024
OAIC	Reference RQ22/00794 and correspondence concerning approximately 1,187 Outlook items under review
Attorney-General's Department	MC23-028244, dated 19 September 2023
Attorney-General's Department	MC25-000321, dated 6 February 2025
Commonwealth Ombudsman	Service-restriction letter dated 8 August 2025
IBAC and ICAC	Relevant complaints, submissions and responses, where held in

	the archive
IGIS	Relevant referral correspondence and associated records
AHRC and international pathways	Human-rights-related correspondence and reference material
NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission	Letter dated 3 June 2021
Comcare	Refusal dated 26 May 2021 and employment-status correspondence
Federal Court-related correspondence	Scott Treadwell letter from January 2024
NSW Trustee & Guardian	Additional $100 weekly allowance, accommodation responsibilities and electricity-bill request
Public Guardian / NCAT	Review material from October 2025 and related correspondence
Legal Aid	Relevant applications, refusals and restrictions
AustralianSuper / AFCA	Financial and insurance-related records

WorkSafe / DXC	Employment-related and administrative records

Repository starting point: github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger
Archive index: index.html
These entries identify records to locate; they do not imply that every source document has already been individually linked from this testimony. Exact file links should be inserted from the actual repository paths so readers can open the specific evidence rather than relying on a guessed URL.

33. PERSONAL TESTIMONY AND HEALTHCARE RECORDS

My account includes repeated psychiatric hospitalisations, which I have recorded as sixteen, and experiences I describe as coercive treatment and chemical restraint.
The evidence index should bring together, where available and appropriate for public release:

- My first-person testimony about the hospitalisations and their consequences.
- Relevant medical and hospital records that I have chosen to include.
- Correspondence concerning treatment, complaints or requests for records.
- The chronology linking these experiences to the wider history.
- My own explanation of the impact on my autonomy, dignity and ability to be heard.

I want readers to understand the difference between the documents themselves and my account of what those experiences meant to me. Neither should be erased.
Repository: Barran Dodger GitHub evidence repository

34. FINANCIAL, EMPLOYMENT AND COMPENSATION RECORDS

The financial and employment-related index should connect:

- CDDC scheme and associated financial records.
- Comcare correspondence and the employee-status question.
- The NDIS Commission letter dated 3 June 2021.
- The January 2024 Scott Treadwell correspondence.
- AustralianSuper and AFCA records.
- WorkSafe, DXC and related employment material.
- Other relevant compensation and administrative correspondence preserved in the archive.

I want these records read as a connected chronology. Their significance lies not only in their individual contents but also in their relationship to the wider circumstances I have documented.
Repository: Barran Dodger GitHub evidence repository

35. CREATIVE WORK, RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

The archive should also preserve the context of my intellectual and creative work, including:

- My PhD from Victoria University, awarded in 2020.
- *Recovered, Not Cured*, published by Allen & Unwin in 2003.
- My work as an illustrator and news graphics artist.
- Relevant gallery and curatorial records.
- Material concerning the DAX Collection and my concerns about the interpretation of

my art.
- Correspondence concerning publishing and media approaches.
- My own writing and first-person testimony.

My creative and academic history is not separate from the person telling this story. It forms part of the context readers need in order to understand my work, my voice and my concerns.

Repository: Barran Dodger GitHub evidence repository · Original archive

36. DIGITAL PRESERVATION AND THE ARCHIVE ITSELF

My preservation work is part of the record.

The original GitHub repository contains the starting point for the preserved website material and related files. The rebuild repository records a separate effort to make the archive accessible without altering the original site.

- Original repository
- Original public site
- Rebuild repository
- Rebuilt public site
- Original index file

The archive is not merely a place where I have placed documents. It is the result of sustained work to preserve a history, organise the source material and give readers a way to navigate it.

I want the documentary record to remain accessible beyond the life of individual conversations, complaint pathways, web pages and institutional responses.

PART III — MY FINAL STATEMENT

37. I REFUSE TO DISAPPEAR

I have spent decades trying to survive, understand, document and communicate a history that I believe exposes serious failures of protection and accountability.

I have approached institutions. I have pursued processes. I have written letters. I have preserved responses. I have assembled documents. I have continued when the work was exhausting and the practical circumstances were difficult.

I have done the work of preserving a record that I believe deserves public attention.

I have done it while carrying the consequences myself.

I will not let my life be reduced to the administrative language of the organisations I have dealt with.

I will not let my education be erased by assumptions about my psychiatric history.

I will not let my creative work be reduced to somebody else's convenient interpretation.

I will not let the absence of media coverage determine whether my story is worth telling.

I will not let a publisher's decision determine whether my documents survive.

I will not let a closed complaint pathway erase the chronology that preceded it.
I will not let institutional silence become the final version of my history.
I will not let poverty, isolation or exhaustion take away my right to speak.
I will continue to preserve the evidence, identify the organisations involved, record the correspondence and explain what I believe the history reveals.
I have a right to my voice. I have a right to my work. I have a right to describe my own experience. I have a right to preserve the documentary record of my life.
My faith remains part of that story. I believe God's grace has sustained me through betrayal, poverty, isolation and loss. I can believe in grace without pretending that betrayal was kindness, that abandonment was support or that silence was accountability.
Truth like light does not need permission to shine or exist.
My truth needed time.
I am still here.
I am Dr Richard William McLean.
I am Barran Dodger.
I am the person who lived this history and who has worked to preserve its record.
THE WITNESS REMAINS.
THE RECORD REMAINS.
AND I WILL NOT BE SILENCED.

———

THE ARCHIVE
Original documentary archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/Barrandodger/
Rebuilt archive: https://wezzo72.github.io/barrandodger-rebuild/
Primary GitHub evidence repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger
Rebuild source repository: https://github.com/wezzo72/barrandodger-rebuild
Original archive index: https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger/blob/main/index.html
Important linking detail: the document now contains contextual links throughout, but most point to the repository or archive as a whole. To turn this into a fully navigable evidence index, the next step is to connect each listed letter, FOI response, PDF and correspondence item to its exact file path in GitHub. That way a reader can open the actual source document directly, rather than having to search the repository.

STAMP & VERIFY

THE WITNESS REMAINS THE PARADOX OF PROTECTION - THE BARRAN DODGER PUBLIC

TESTIMONY, DOCUMENTARY RECORD AND EVIDENCE INDEX.pdf 210.9 kB
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